

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in regulatory and compliance-focused legal work, document review, drafting, and case management at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Adobe. Familiar with UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 in a commercial context, and experienced in managing matters from instruction to submission, communicating with clients on sensitive matters, and maintaining organised records under competing deadlines. Particular interest in developing expertise in financial services regulation and technology-facing compliance work.

EDUCATION

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| Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit
Queen Mary University of London | Sept 2024 – Oct 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, legal research and evidence analysis• Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75% | |
| Law LLB — 2:1
University College London | Sept 2020 – June 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modules included Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law | |
| International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations
King's College London | Sept 2019 – June 2020 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; carried partial funding toward undergraduate degree) | |

EXPERIENCE

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| Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead
Legal Adviser | July 2026 – Present |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Manages a caseload spanning welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters from client instruction through to submission• Takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues• Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex regulatory points• Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains confidential case records to deadline• Translates complex regulatory requirements into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable clients | |
| Q-Legal · London
Legal Adviser | Oct 2024 – Jan 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision• Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech• Identified compliance risks from the client's data processing practices and recommended practical mitigations• Translated complex statutory requirements into commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline | |
| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration | Feb 2024 – Aug 2024 |

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline; coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time filing
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the memorial; conducted legal research
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translations
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles, and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Flagged provisions requiring legal input, communicated amendments to stakeholders, and prepared an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking, compliance documentation